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INTRODUCTION

Using Collocations is a self-study book for intermediate to upper-intermediate students. Each unit presents between sixteen and twenty-four collocations and practises them in a wide variety of contexts, from tweets to e-mails, postcards to letters, adverts to newspaper articles.

Throughout the book, there is an emphasis on learning to use collocations *appropriately*, so they are always presented in typical contexts, and information on formality or informality is included.

As well as using a range of text types, examples of conversational English are included. Some texts are recorded so that students are able to notice particular features of stress and intonation.

Why learn collocations?

Collocations are the key to fluent, elegant English. Learning words on their own may enable us to communicate, but unless we learn the other words that go with them in a natural, typical way, our English will always be clumsy. The collocations in this book will help students improve the way they use the words they already know.

The structure of the book

This book is made up of twenty-four units, each consisting of two double-page sections. Every four units, there is a two-page review. The first four units serve as a useful introduction to collocations, but otherwise it is not necessary to work through the units in any particular sequence.

- **Units 1–4** explain what collocations are and show the most common ways of forming them.
- **Units 5–8** take very common concepts (e.g. good and bad, success) and present more interesting ways of expressing these ideas using collocations.
- **Units 9–13** cover aspects of collocation such as register (how formal or informal words are) and metaphor.
- **Units 14–20** show collocations presented in topic groups (e.g. relationships, work).
- **Units 21–24** cover functional English, such as how to use collocations for emphasis, and collocations connected with expressing your feelings.

How the units work

The units are divided into two sections, each of which presents between eight and twelve collocations. In each section, the first exercise introduces the collocations in a simple way, to ensure that their meanings are clear.

In the exercises that follow, the collocations are used in a variety of contexts, so that by the end of the section, students will not only understand them, but be able to use them with confidence.

There are many different types of exercise, ensuring there is an opportunity for thorough and varied practice. They might involve using collocations to answer questions on a text, rewriting texts in a better style, doing crosswords, gaps-fills, matching sentence halves or writing sentences with opposite meanings.

Answers are given in the key at the back of the book, and any exercises with the  symbol are also supplied as recordings.

Review sections

After every four units, there is a two-page review section. In each of these, there are sixty simple questions using collocations from the previous units. Students can test themselves and use the answer key to check their progress.

Index

An index is included at the back of the book, listing the first instance of all the collocations in alphabetical order.

To the student

As you use this book, you will probably become more sensitive to collocations. Try to make collocations part of your learning strategy at all times. Once you start noticing them, you will find they are everywhere in all kinds of formal and informal contexts: on TV, in the news, and in all forms of advertising, for example.

All good monolingual (English only) learners' dictionaries contain useful information about collocations, often shown in **bold type** in example sentences. If you look up a new word in your dictionary, remember to check whether it has any typical collocations that you should learn with it.

When you come across new words in writing or speech, try to notice what other words are used with them. If the word is a noun, for example, has the writer or speaker used an interesting verb or adjective with it? If so, make a note of that too.

Make use the index. You can refer to it to check the context for a collocation you have come across, or to help you test yourself or revise what you have learned.

To the teacher

This book is primarily intended for self-study, but the exercises can be used in class or for homework too. They can be used to supplement work in a course book. The contents map and index will help you to plan activities related to whatever other material you are using.

Each section contains a *Classroom extra* activity which is a suggestion for a more communicative use of the material in the classroom. For instance, some of these activities encourage students to use the collocations they have learned in speech or writing of their own, while others involve class discussion of a text they have worked on.

1 WHAT ARE COLLOCATIONS?

Collocations in the news

Collocations are words that go together, often in ways that we do not expect. Collocations go together more than they would by chance: they **belong** together. In the following exercises, we look at the way we choose word partners to help us make natural sounding sentences.

Study tip

The collocations in this part of the unit are often used in news reports. Try to look out for other collocations when you read the newspaper or watch the news on TV.

1 **Find two words in each box that form collocations with the words 1–10 in bold. Use a dictionary to help you if necessary.**

heavy • ~~sustain~~ • serious • obtain • establish • soft

1 sustain
2 _____ **injuries**

heavy • change • move • easy • level • divert

3 _____
4 _____ **traffic**

heavy • major • exist • pose • large • challenge

5 **a** _____
6 _____ **a** **threat**

heavy • strong • start • brutal • launch • operate

7 _____ **an**
8 **a** _____ **attack**

heed • see • find • listen • notify • ignore

9 _____
10 _____ **warnings**

2 **Match the collocations in Exercise 1 to the definitions 1–10.**

1 to be something that may cause danger or difficulty pose a threat
2 to start to criticise or harm someone
3 bad damage to someone's body
4 to listen when someone tells you that something bad might happen
5 to make cars, lorries, etc., take a different route
6 a very serious danger or difficulty
7 a very violent act which hurts someone
8 to be physically harmed
9 a lot of cars, lorries, etc.
10 not to listen when someone tells you something bad might happen

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Divide your students into groups and ask them to come up with collocations they already know. If necessary, prompt them with simple collocations e.g. *drive a car, clean your teeth, a sunny day*. You could turn this into a competition by giving the class a set time to do this. The group with the most collocations wins.

3 **Find the collocations you have learned above in newspaper articles 1–4 and <u>underline</u> them.**

1

Girl attacked

Police are hunting for two youths they believe may be responsible for a brutal attack on a teenage girl last week. Amy Whitehead was repeatedly punched in the face and sustained injuries that needed hospital treatment. A police spokesperson said, 'It is astonishing that an attack like this can happen in daylight, in a busy street. These people pose a threat to the public and must be caught.'

2

GREEN CAMPAIGNERS SAY NO TO CHEAP FLIGHTS

Environmental campaigners yesterday launched an attack on airline companies for offering cut-price flights to popular holiday destinations. One of them told us, 'We have seen how fast the ice caps are melting. If we ignore these warnings for the sake of a cheap holiday, our children and grandchildren will suffer.' Holiday makers disagreed. 'The weather here is so miserable, we need to get away!' said one.

3

Flood drama in local village

Residents in the village of Little Brook who failed to heed warnings of flooding found themselves trapped yesterday when more than six inches of rain fell in just three hours. Police had to divert traffic after roads were closed by the floods, and many home owners battled to keep the water out of their houses. A woman was taken to hospital with serious injuries when a tree fell on the car she was driving.

4

TRAFFIC THREAT TO SHOPPING STREET

Shopkeepers say that heavy traffic is putting off visitors to the picturesque village of East Chipping. Three hundred people have signed a petition asking for a bypass. 'We want people to enjoy shopping in a pleasant and peaceful environment,' said Glyn Evans, owner of a shop selling fishing equipment. 'The current levels of traffic are a major threat to our businesses.'

4 **Complete the sentences using the collocations you have learned above. Make sure you use the correct form of the verbs.**

1 Two youths carried out a _____ on Amy Whitehouse.

2 She had to go to hospital because of the _____ she _____ .

3 While the youths who attacked Amy are free, they _____ a _____ to all of us.

4 Green campaigners have _____ an _____ on companies who encourage people to fly more.

5 There may be terrible consequences if we _____ about global warming.

6 Some people in Little Brook were trapped in their homes because they did not _____ about the floods.

7 Police _____ around Little Brook because some of the roads were flooded.

8 When a tree fell on a car in Little Brook, the driver sustained _____ .

9 People do not want to shop in streets where there is _____ .

10 Heavy traffic is a _____ to shops in East Chipping.

Make it more interesting

Sound natural

Next time you want to use a word such as *very, really, big,* etc., think about the collocations you know. Can you express it differently?

Collocations can often be used as more interesting alternatives for very common words. Using simple single words may sometimes sound rather unsophisticated, whereas choosing collocations will show that you have a good knowledge of English.

5 **Read the e-mails and look at the collocations in bold. Match one of the words in each collocation to one of the common words 1–9.**

1 **bad:** nasty negative
2 **big:** _____
3 **get:** _____
4 **complete:** _____
5 **take:** _____
6 **very:** _____ _____
7 **new:** _____
8 **very well:** _____ _____
9 **improve:** _____

From: Camilla Deschamps
To: Brendan Flowerdew
Subject: Office space

Hi Brendan
I've just heard that there's some office space free near the Victoria Road roundabout. Do you know it? As far as I can see, it's **ideally suited** to our needs, and I know Steve's been **worried sick** about what we're going to do when the new development team starts. The person who told me about it says it's well furnished and **spotlessly clean**. Would you be free to come with me to take a look this afternoon?
Cheers
Camilla

From: Camilla Deschamps
To: Olga Strauss
Subject: Staff matters

Dear Olga
Could we meet some time tomorrow to discuss yesterday's incident with the customer support team? I must say that seeing it splashed all over the local paper was a very **nasty surprise**, as I would have expected you to have reported the matter to me immediately. As a company, we have worked hard to **earn a reputation** for professional service, and I'll be expecting a **full explanation** when we meet. Unless I hear from you, I'll see you at 11a.m. in my office.
Yours
Camilla

From: Camilla Deschamps
To: Dilip Patel
Subject: Training courses

Dear Dilip (if I may)
Thanks for your brochure which arrived last week. You certainly offer a **wide range** of training courses, and some of them look ideal for our needs. We always like to make sure that our staff are **highly trained**, and are constantly trying to find ways to **enhance the quality** of our work. Could you ring me to discuss dates and prices, please?
Best wishes
Camilla

From: Camilla Deschamps
To: Stephen Goss
Subject: Olga Strauss

Dear Stephen
Just a note to tell you that I'm seeing Olga tomorrow about the customer support issue. To be honest, I'm not sure she's really up to the job of managing such an important team. She has allowed some very **negative attitudes** to develop, and they don't seem to be able to **seize opportunities** for sales in the way they did when Kelly was in charge. I'm wondering if we should think about making a **fresh start** with a new manager.
Best
Camilla

6 **Are the statements true (T) or false (F)?**

1 Camilla doesn't think the offices near the Victoria Road bridge are suitable.
2 There is already plenty of office space for the new development team.
3 The local paper had an embarrassing article about Camilla's company.
4 Olga Strauss wrote a report on the incident in her department.
5 Camilla wants to book some training for her staff.
6 Camilla thinks it is important to train staff properly.
7 Camilla thinks that Olga is a good manager.
8 Camilla is thinking of removing Olga from her job.

7 **The sentences below are from three adverts, but they are mixed up. First, replace the underlined part of each sentence with the collocations you have learned above. Then put the sentences in the correct order to complete the adverts.**

MOLLY'S MECHANICS

1 That's understandable – there's nothing worse than the unpleasant shock of an enormous bill for repairs you don't understand.

2 That's why our all-female gang of mechanics has become well known for good work and honest prices.

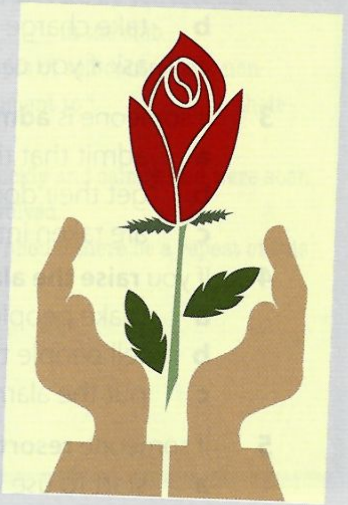
3 Does your car need servicing? Are you very anxious about the cost?

4 No need to worry any more: we will give you a complete explanation of what needs doing to your car and how much it will cost, **before** we do the work.



JOHN ORAM: LIFE COACH

❶ This can be done by learning to reject bad ideas about everything and concentrate on positive thoughts and actions.



❷ How? I can help you unlock your mind and take the chances that life offers.

❸ Spend an hour with me and improve your life.

❹ So, if you want to leave your problems behind and start again, call me today!

Celebration Dining Co.



1 Most importantly, all our chefs have had a lot of training, so whatever your event, the food will be delicious.

2 From dinner for two to a feast for two hundred, we are the best people to supply all your catering needs.

3 And finally, all the food is prepared in our extremely clean kitchens and brought direct to you – no fuss, no preparation, no mess.

4 In addition, there is a large selection of menus, so that everyone can find dishes they like.

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Ask students to write an advert of their own using some of the collocations they have learned or other collocations they know or can find in a dictionary.

2 VERB + NOUN AND VERB + ADVERB COLLOCATIONS

Verbs and nouns

There are many collocations formed with a verb and a noun. The verb is the word that 'operates' the noun. In other words, you need the verb to use the noun in a natural way. Although it is often possible to use a very simple verb which can go with many different nouns, your English will sound much better if you learn some specific verbs to use with particular nouns. Often these verb + noun combinations are impossible to guess. When you are adding a new noun to your vocabulary book, try to find out the verb or verbs that form a collocation with that noun and write these down too.

1 **Circle the correct answer. Use a dictionary to help you if necessary.**

1 If you **restore confidence** in something, you:
- **a** make people trust it again.
- **b** insist that it is worth a lot of money.
- **c** make people feel confident.

2 If you **assume control** of a situation, you:
- **a** think that you should be in charge.
- **b** take charge of it.
- **c** ask if you can be in charge of it.

3 If someone is **admitted to hospital**, they:
- **a** admit that they have been in hospital.
- **b** get their doctor to agree that they should go to hospital.
- **c** are taken into hospital for treatment.

4 If you **raise the alarm**, you:
- **a** make people more worried.
- **b** tell people that something is wrong.
- **c** put the alarm in a higher place.

5 If someone **resorts to violence**, they:
- **a** start to use violence.
- **b** use violence on holiday.
- **c** try to prevent violence.

6 If you **deny responsibility** for something, you:
- **a** say that you do not want to be responsible for it.
- **b** say it was not your fault.
- **c** say that people are lying about it.

Study tip

The words in a collocation do not always have to come right next to each other. With verb + noun collocations, the verb can sometimes be quite a long way from the noun it operates.

2 **Underline the verb that operates the noun in bold in the sentences.**

1 The managers issued a formal, written **warning** to all staff that strike action could result in dismissal.
2 At our school, we attach a great deal of **importance** to the creative arts.
3 In an attempt to cause trouble amongst other family members, she spread a lot of completely false **rumours** about their private lives.
4 Her main criticism of the school was that **discipline** was not enforced sufficiently.
5 Although she had always acted professionally in the past, it seems that on this occasion personal involvement clouded the nurse's **judgement**.
6 I think we're expending far too much of our **energy** worrying about things that don't really matter.

3 **Complete the sentences with collocations from Exercises 1 and 2. Make sure you use the correct form of the verbs.**

1 Two men were _____ to _____ suffering from the effects of the smoke.
2 I need to fix the problem. I've _____ far too much _____ on it already.
3 If you are a lawyer, you cannot allow your feelings to _____ your _____ .
4 Sometimes I feel that our society doesn't _____ much _____ to ideas like generosity and politeness.
5 It will take more than a few tax cuts to _____ in this government.
6 In the event of the death of the president, the vice president would _____ of the country immediately.

4 **There has been trouble at the kung fu club. Try to memorise the collocations you learned in Exercise 1 and 2. Use them to complete the letter from the chief instructor to the parents.**

King Street
KUNG FU CLUB 武

Dear Parents

Some of you will be aware that an incident at the club last week resulted in two boys being [1]_____ to _____ with minor injuries. This letter is to reassure you that the situation has been dealt with firmly, and – we hope – to [2]_____ in the club.

As you know, we [3]_____ great _____ to the concepts of self-control and non-violence. Sadly, it appears that these boys allowed a personal argument to [4]_____ their _____ on this occasion.

We can assure you that the instructors dealt with the incident quickly and calmly, and were soon able to [5]_____ of the situation. No other children were involved.

We have [6]_____ a _____ to the boys involved, and should there be a repeat of this kind of behaviour, they will be asked to leave the club.

Please feel free to contact me if you have any further questions.

Doug Fairchild
Chief Instructor

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Ask your students to identify the differences in the instructor's version and the mother's version of events.

5 **Here is one of the mothers talking to her friend about the same incident. Replace the underlined phrases with the collocations you have learned above. Listen to the recording to check your answers.**

'Apparently, the instructors were just chatting in the corner when it happened, and it was my Edward who [1] told them something bad was happening. By that time, the two lads were rolling on the floor, kicking and biting each other, and the instructors had to [2] be quite violent with them to get them apart.

Apparently, one of the boys had been [3] telling everyone that the other one's dad was in prison. The instructors are [4] saying it wasn't their fault, but from what I've heard, they don't [5] make the children behave properly in the club. And isn't that what kung fu's supposed to be all about?

It seems to me that the kids [6] use up a lot more energy messing around than they do learning martial arts. I'm going to look for another club for Edward to join.'



Nouns and intransitive verbs, verbs and adverbs

If the collocation is formed from a subject and an intransitive verb (a verb which does not have an object after it), then the verb will come **after** the noun. Try to get into the habit of noticing the grammatical patterns of collocations you see, so that you are able to use them accurately yourself.

6 **Complete the sentences with verbs from the box. Make sure you use the correct form of the verbs. Each verb makes a collocation with the noun in bold.**

pound • strike • buckle • break out

1 We were had just gone to bed when the **earthquake** _____ .
2 He joined the army as soon as **war** _____ .
3 Suddenly, I started to feel faint, and my **legs** _____ under me.
4 My **heart** starts to _____ every time I see him.

7 **Underline the correct adverb to form a collocation to complete each sentence. Use a dictionary to help you if necessary.**

1 I was trying to make a pink dinosaur cake, but I got into such a mess that I decided to throw it away and **start alternatively/cleanly/afresh**.
2 When I was younger, I **travelled broadly/extensively/greatly** in Asia.
3 I'm afraid his attempts to speak French made me **laugh widely/afresh/aloud**.
4 After all that exercise, we should **sleep soundly/profoundly/heavily** tonight.
5 He felt able to **talk clearly/openly/genuinely** about his feelings.
6 I don't know Alice, but George **speaks happily/largely/highly** of her work.

8 **Match what the speakers 1–6 say to the descriptions a–f on page 13.**

1 'She's an excellent colleague. She is very efficient, and meets all her deadlines. She has written an excellent report for me this quarter.'

2 'I was the sales rep for South America. I usually spent alternate months in the London office and in one of our offices over there – most often Brazil, but sometimes Argentina or Ecuador. From there, I'd go out to visit our main clients in all the major cities.'

3 'At the beginning of the war I found myself stuck in Switzerland, where I'd been studying, because there was no available transport home for several weeks.'

4 'When the floods came, we had to abandon all our belongings – there was no time to pack them up. Afterwards, it was too painful to go back to our village, so we decided to move to another island and set up a restaurant, which is something I'd always wanted to do.'

5 'In the morning, everyone was talking about the bomb. It went off right outside our apartment block, but I hadn't heard a thing. Nobody could believe that I hadn't been woken up by the noise, or by the ambulance sirens afterwards.'

6 'I've been in a relationship with a very nice man for over a year, and he wants to marry me. The trouble is, I like him a lot, but I'm not sure I love him enough. Recently, I've met someone at work who I'm really attracted to.'

Sound natural

Look (and listen) out for collocations you have learned. Noticing them on TV or in print helps you to use them naturally.

a He **spoke** very **highly** of her work.
b She **talked openly** about her feelings.
c She **slept soundly**, despite the noise outside.
d He was abroad when **war broke out**.
e He **travelled extensively** for his work.
f They left their old lives behind and **started afresh**.

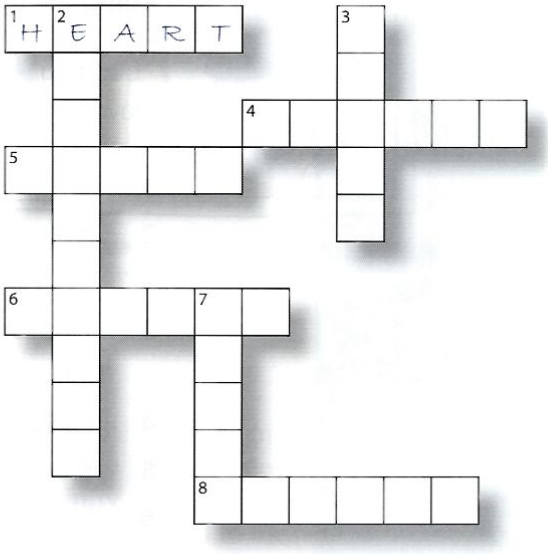
9 **Complete the sentences with the collocations you have learned above. Make sure you use the correct form of the verbs. Then complete the crossword.**

Across

1 As I stood up to speak, my heart was pounding.
4 If war _____ out, you will have to return home.
5 We decided to leave our country and _____ afresh.
6 We saw the bullet hit him and his legs _____ .
8 He always speaks _____ of his colleagues.

Down

2 What should you do if an _____ strikes?
3 The fresh air will help you _____ soundly.
7 Her jokes made us _____ aloud.



10 **Chris is e-mailing Julie to tell her some exciting news. However, his adverbs are with the wrong verbs. Match the six verbs and adverbs correctly.**

From: Christopher Tucker
To: Julie Gibbs
Subject: Big news!

Hi Julie
I've got some exciting news to tell you – Rose and I are giving up our jobs and we're planning to open an art gallery in Brighton!
I know this is all a bit sudden, but we treated ourselves to a weekend in a luxury hotel recently, and when Rose made a joke over dinner, I suddenly realised that it was the first time that I'd laughed ~~afresh~~ aloud for weeks. Isn't that awful? So then we both started to talk soundly about how much we hated our jobs and our lives, and we quickly realised that we needed to start aloud before it's too late. After that conversation, I felt as if a weight had been lifted off me, and I slept openly for the first time in years.
I've always had a particular interest in Asian art, and I know that people speak extensively of many contemporary Asian artists. So our plan is to spend six months travelling highly in India and Pakistan, and then to come back and set up the shop.
Anyway, I know you'll be excited for us, and we'd love to see you before we set off on our travels.
All the best,
Chris

CLASSROOM EXTRA

In pairs, students choose three words from the collocations in this unit and make mini crosswords like the one in Exercise 9. They then write their own gap-fill clues and swap them with another pair.

3 ADJECTIVE + NOUN COLLOCATIONS

Man and nature

Adjective + noun collocations are among the very first collocations you learn, because they help you to form precise descriptions. As your English improves, they allow you to describe things in interesting and varied ways.

1 **Complete the sentences with adjectives from the box.**

budding • torrential • heavy • lasting • brisk • regular • complete • gentle • favourable • natural • enviable • close

1 _____ **snow** had fallen overnight and many of the roads were closed.
2 It is very dangerous to ski off-piste because avalanches are a _____ **occurrence** around here.
3 I did some French at school, but it was so long ago that I decided I should start again in a class for _____ **beginners**.
4 Luckily, the floods didn't do any _____ **damage** to the buildings.
5 We stayed inside all weekend because of the _____ **rain**.
6 He says he doesn't want to go to the party, but really he just needs a little _____ **persuasion**.
7 A _____ **walk** will help us get over that huge lunch.
8 The Barrier Reef is an area of great _____ **beauty**.
9 Our town has _____ **links** with a town in Germany.
10 From everything he told me in his letters, I formed a very _____ **impression** of his family.
11 I have to fit in my training around my job, but Joe is in the _____ **position** of not having to work because he inherited a lot of money from an uncle.
12 Friends have been watching the _____ **romance** between Zoe and Zac with interest.

2 **Match the collocations in Exercise 1 to the sentences below.**

1 If you get this, the snow will be deep.
2 If you are in one of these, people think you are lucky.
3 If you have these with an organisation, you are strongly connected with them.
4 If this happens, something cannot be repaired.
5 If someone tries this, they try gently to make you do what they want.
6 If you have one of these, you are starting to fall in love.
7 If you are one of these, you have never done something before.
8 If a place has this, it is beautiful in a way that has nothing to do with people.
9 If you get this, a lot of rain falls.
10 If you have this, you think that something seems good.
11 If something is one of these, it happens often.
12 If you go on one of these, you walk fast and with energy.

3 **Read these students' reports on school trips in the school magazine. Rewrite the reports using the collocations in the boxes.**

lasting damage • regular occurrence • complete beginner • heavy snow

SKIING IN THE ALPS, BY ARCHIE LEYS

We could hardly believe our luck! There had been ~~a lot of~~ heavy snow the previous week, and – even better – we found ourselves treated to a week of bright sunshine. Mid-morning hot chocolate in an outdoor café in just our T-shirts became a habit, and many of us came home with suntans. A few people had skied before, but most of us had never skied at all. Inevitably, there were a few bumps and bruises, but happily nobody had any long-term injuries, and a great time was had by all!



close links • enviable position • favourable impression • budding romance

EXCHANGE TRIP TO FRANCE, BY TOMAS TSE

Lower Heath school has been strongly connected with the lyceé in Paris for many years, and this July, forty of us set off on coaches to meet the students who have been our penfriends all year. I immediately decided that I liked my host family when I found a large box of chocolates on my bed! We went out a lot, to museums, shops and to the cinema. I must admit that my penfriend enjoyed the film more than I did, being in the lucky situation of speaking French much better than me! Everyone enjoyed a week of cultural exchange, language learning, and (in some cases) starting to fall in love a little!

natural beauty • gentle persuasion • brisk walk • torrential rain

GEOGRAPHY TRIP TO THE LAKE DISTRICT, BY AISHA MALIK

As I looked out of the hostel window at the rain lashing down outside, I wondered what on earth had made me decide to do geography. Still, after some encouraging words from the teachers, we put on our wet weather gear and headed off for a fast, energetic hike up Scafell Pike, the highest mountain in England. It was a lot further than it looked to the top, but when we got there we had our reward – the rain stopped, the clouds disappeared, and we could see why people say the Lake District is an area where nature's beauty is so great.



Study tip

Next time you do a piece of writing, look at it critically. Can you improve the style?

4 **Answer the questions about the school trips, using the collocations in brackets.**

1 Was there plenty of snow for the skiers? (heavy snow)
2 Had everyone been skiing before? (complete beginner)
3 Were the students eager to go outside into the rain? (gentle persuasion)
4 What impressed them about Scafell Pike? (natural beauty)
5 Had Lower Heath school had any connection with the lyceé before? (close links)
6 Why did Tomas's penfriend enjoy the film more than he did? (enviable position)

CLASSROOM EXTRA

In pairs, ask your students to write an answer to the following questions.
1 Describe a time when you have had to use gentle persuasion.
2 Describe someone who is in an enviable position and say why.
3 Describe someone who made a favourable impression on you and say why.
Ask some of them to read out their answers.

Two sides to the story

The adjective + noun collocations in these exercises are often found in news reports. The language is 'official' rather than informal or colloquial.



5 **George Petradis is a company director whose company premises were set on fire. Mark Lee is the main suspect. Read what they both say, paying particular attention to the collocations in bold. Match the collocations to definitions 1–10. Then listen to the recording.**

Study tip

The next time you read or listen to a news report, particularly about a crime, listen out for the collocations being used and make a note of them in your vocabulary book.

George Petradis

'I got a phone call on Sunday afternoon, telling me that there'd been a fire in my offices. I assumed a piece of equipment had been left on over the weekend and over-heated or that there had been an electrical fault. Apparently, when the fire crew arrived, they realised straight away that it was a **deliberate attempt** at arson, and they called the police.

It took nearly two hours to put the fire out, and when I saw the **full extent** of the damage, I was really shocked. It was obvious that whoever did it had some **prior knowledge** of the premises. They knew just where to pour their petrol, and had even had a key to one of the offices. I immediately had my suspicions – I'd had to sack one of my employees a while ago. He'd been very unhappy about it and made a big fuss.

A **major breakthrough** came when a woman contacted the police and gave a **detailed description** of a man she had seen near the premises on the afternoon of the fire. Her description matched my ex-employee. The police managed to get fingerprint evidence and even a baseball cap with the DNA of this guy on it, and he is due in court soon.'

Mark Lee

'Of course I didn't do it. After all, who in their right minds would go and set fire to an office in **broad daylight**? All they've really got is **anecdotal evidence** from my ex-boss about how we didn't get on. It's true that he was a nightmare to work for, but that doesn't mean I'd burn the place down, does it?

Anyway, they haven't got any **conclusive proof**. I mean, I worked there so it's not surprising they found my fingerprints. That baseball cap was probably there from when I worked there too. It's ridiculous. Now I have to put up with a load of **malicious gossip** from people, and my kids are getting teased at school. And worse, there's a **strong possibility** that I'll end up in prison for something I didn't do.'

1 a very important piece of progress
2 a statement describing all the small details of something
3 unpleasant talk about someone
4 the complete amount of something
5 when someone tries to do something on purpose
6 the time when it is light
7 proof which is only based on what people have said about someone or something
8 things that show for certain what is true
9 knowing about something before the present time
10 when something is very likely

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Ask your students to discuss whether they think Mark Lee is innocent or guilty. They should give reasons, using the collocations they have learned where possible.

6 **Rewrite the sentences using the collocations in brackets.**

1 After the fire was put out, Petradis saw how much damage there was. (full extent)
After the fire was put out, Petradis saw the full extent of the damage .

2 Lee says the police have no real evidence that he is guilty. (conclusive proof)
Lee says the police _____ .

3 It is quite likely that Lee will go to prison. (strong possibility)
There is _____ .

4 The office was set on fire in the daytime. (broad daylight)
The office was _____ .

5 Lee says that the case against him is based on stories. (anecdotal evidence)
Lee says that the case against him _____ .

6 Lee complains about the nasty things that people are saying about him in the village. (malicious gossip)
Lee complains about _____ .

7 The woman told the police exactly what the man looked like. (detailed description)
The woman gave the police _____ .

8 The woman's description was very useful for the police. (major breakthrough)
The woman's description was _____ .

9 Someone had tried to burn down the office on purpose. (deliberate attempt)
Someone had made _____ .

10 The police said he knew a lot about the premises already. (prior knowledge)
The police said he had _____ .

7 **Use the collocations you have learned above to complete the newspaper articles.**

NEW CANCER HOPE

Scientists are celebrating a [1]_____ _____ in the fight against cancer. A new treatment has shown extremely positive results in tests. The [2]_____ _____ of patients' improvement will not be known for six months, when all the data has been collected and analysed and a [3]_____ _____ of the drug's effects can be published. However, doctors say there is a [4]_____ _____ that this treatment will become standard within two years.

Singer's photo fury

Singer Jay Jordan has no love for journalists. Since being photographed kissing and cuddling a mystery blonde in Central Park in [5]_____ _____, the married father-of-three has hit back at the papers. 'There has been a lot of [6]_____ _____ about my private life. It's a [7]_____ _____ to blacken my name. My marriage is rock solid.'

MINISTER MAKES GOOD START

Although the minister arrived in her post with little or no [8]_____ _____ of the defence industry, insiders say she has made an impressive start. [9]_____ _____ suggests that she is well-liked in the department. She is known to be consulting widely, and more [10]_____ _____ of her ability will come next week, when she is due to give her first major speech as minister.

4 OTHER TYPES OF COLLOCATION

Adverb/Verb + adjective

It is common to find adjectives forming collocations with adverbs or verbs which come before them. These exercises show you some useful examples of this type of collocation.

1 **Complete the postcards with adjectives from the box.**

short • accustomed • awake • asleep • populated • baked • available • surprised • lit • empty

Hi Paul

Here we are in our little chalet in the Alps! We've been **pleasantly** [1] _____ by the standard of the accommodation, which is very comfortable. We start each morning with **freshly** [2] _____ bread and croissants from the café down the road, and we've even **grown** [3] _____ to driving on the narrow mountain roads – the scenery is absolutely amazing!

See you soon, Alex

Dear Mum

Can't wait to get out of this place. It's so humid that I **lie** [4] _____ most nights, and if it's not the heat that stops me **falling** [5] _____, it's feeling sick. All the restaurants are really **dimly** [6] _____ and I think it's so that we can't see what we're eating! The food here is really terrible – that's probably why there aren't many tourists. Lots of the hotels here are **standing** [7] _____ – I'm not surprised.

Hope to see you very soon!

Lots of love, Ryan

Hi Rick

Hong Kong is just brilliant – you must come here some time! It's really **densely** [8] _____, but it's a really fun place to be. There's fantastic food **freely** [9] _____ at any time of the day or night, and you never **run** [10] _____ of things to do here. We're due to fly home on Saturday, but I don't want to leave!

Cheers, Billy

Study tip

Look out for other collocations with words such as 'freshly'. Adverts are an interesting source of collocations. Notice how the language is designed to make things more appealing.

2 **Answer the questions, using the collocations in brackets. Make sure you use the correct form of the verbs.**

1 Is Alex pleased with his accommodation? (pleasantly surprised)
2 What does Alex have for breakfast? (freshly baked)
3 Is driving in the mountains difficult for Alex? (grow accustomed)
4 Does Ryan sleep well at night? (lie awake)
5 Why can't Ryan see his food very well? (dimly lit)
6 What is Ryan having problems doing? (fall asleep)
7 Are all the hotels in the area full? (stand empty)
8 Does Hong Kong have a lot of buildings? (densely populated)
9 Is it easy to get food in Hong Kong? (freely available)
10 Are you likely to be bored in Hong Kong? (run short)

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Ask your students to write a postcard to a friend, describing somewhere they have been, and using some of the collocations they have learned.

3 **Complete the sentences using the collocations you have learned above. Make sure you use the correct form of the verbs.**

1 We enjoyed working on the farm, and we soon _____ _____ to the long hours.
2 Developers bought up all the land, but then the economy collapsed, and all their luxury flats are _____ _____ .
3 If you _____ _____ of bread, get some more out of the freezer.
4 Most of my meat-eating friends are _____ _____ when I cook them a vegetarian meal.
5 I spent the whole night _____ _____ worrying that I hadn't prepared well enough for my exam.
6 The virus is likely to spread more rapidly in _____ _____ urban areas such as this.
7 Everyone loves to wake up to the smell of _____ _____ bread.
8 The optician told him he had damaged his eyes by working in a _____ _____ room.
9 Information about health matters is _____ _____ on the internet.
10 The talk was so boring that half the audience _____ _____ .

4 **The friends who wrote these e-mails made eight mistakes with their collocations. Find the mistakes and correct them.**

From: Kitty
To: Patsy
Subject: Restaurant

Hi Patsy!
Well, I've survived my first term at uni! I must admit that I spent the first week staying awake at night, worrying about everything, but once I'd turned accustomed to the amount of work, I really started enjoying it, and I've found that there is plenty of help and advice cheaply available if you need it. I'm coming home next weekend because I'm coming short of clean clothes and I never seem to have time to do any washing! Hope to see you then, and find out how you're getting on at the restaurant.
Love, Kitty, x

From: Patsy
To: Kitty
Subject: Restaurant

Hi Kitty
Great to hear from you. Sounds like you're having a great time, and I'm really jealous! The restaurant has been a disaster – nobody can afford to eat out these days. You should see how many shops are staying empty around here! You'd think that an area as thickly populated as this would be able to support a bistro, but we're really struggling. Things are so slow that I spend half my time sitting behind the bar, and I have to struggle not to drop asleep. Still, we were happily surprised to get a booking for 35 people next week, so perhaps things will start to look up soon. It would be lovely to see you next weekend – give me a ring when you get home.
Love, Patsy, x

Noun *of* noun, adjective *and* adjective

These exercises focus on two-noun and two-adjective collocations (for example, *hive of activity* and *safe and sound*). Notice also the use of conjunctions.

Study tip

Notice the rhythm of these collocations. Say them aloud to yourself to help memorise them.

5 **Complete the explanations of the collocations with one noun from box A and one noun from box B.**

A blaze • catalogue • torrent • ~~hive~~ • bundle • chorus

B abuse • publicity • errors • approval • ~~activity~~ • nerves

1 If a place is extremely busy, it is a *hive* **of** *activity* .
2 A _____ **of** _____ is when many people say they like something.
3 Someone who is very anxious is a _____ **of** _____ .
4 If someone makes a _____ **of** _____ , they make lots of mistakes.
5 If you do something in a _____ **of** _____ , it is widely reported in the media.
6 If someone shouts a _____ **of** _____ , they say many nasty things.

6 **Solve the anagram in brackets to complete the collocations in the sentences.**

1 Thankfully, the children were found **safe and** *sound* . (dsoun)
2 She appeared **calm and** _____ , despite the shock. (llocceedt)
3 It is important that our staff are **neat and** _____ at all times. (dyit)
4 He was **sick and** _____ of other people telling him what to do. (rtied)
5 The tragedies in her life had made her very **bitter and** _____ . (wtsidet)
6 Flora is too **prim and** _____ to dance on the table. (roppre)

7 **Look at descriptions 1–8 of people at work. Work out who is being talked about by reading sentences a–h on page 21.**

1 There had been a problem with staff arriving late, owing to heavy traffic and family commitments. When he suggested more flexible hours, the staff were delighted, and the managers agreed that this could benefit the company. *h*
2 Her boss had already asked her to work late twice that week, and she'd had to work through her lunch breaks. On Friday evening, he told her she had to finish a long report over the weekend. She was so angry, she told him to find another assistant.
3 In one corner, people were bent over large sheets of paper making sketches, and in another, rolls of material were being inspected. Phones rang constantly, and people came in and out with documents, fabric samples and trays of coffee.
4 She paced up and down, checking her notes, smoothing down the front of her jacket, trying to take deep breaths and sipping water to wet her dry mouth.
5 He had been in the same job for ten years without being promoted. He was negative about everything, and very unpleasant to work with.
6 He obviously chose the date of his resignation to cause the maximum damage to the government. Photographers camped outside his house all night when they heard he would make a statement in the morning.
7 Speaking slowly and clearly, he confirmed that the skeleton was that of an ancient dinosaur, and was more complete than any other of the same type. Then he politely answered a few questions, and said he had to get back to work.
8 She wouldn't dream of leaving the office without putting her papers away. She keeps all her pens in a special pot, and her books neatly stacked by her computer.

a Eva's office was a hive of activity.
b Rose always keeps her desk very neat and tidy.
c Kazuo announced the discovery in a calm and collected manner.
d Hector quit his job in a blaze of publicity.
e Jeanne was sick and tired of her boss's demands.
f Sonja was a bundle of nerves before her speech.
g Constant disappointment had make Andrew bitter and twisted.
h ~~Adam's suggestions were greeted with a chorus of approval.~~

CLASSROOM EXTRA

In pairs, ask your students to choose one of the collocations they have learned and to make up a situation that describes it, as in descriptions 1–8 in Exercise 7. Students take it in turns to read out their situations, and the rest of the class has to guess their collocation.

8 **Complete the sentences using the collocations you have learned above.**



1 We're off to visit my aunt this afternoon. She's rather _____ , so we'll have to be careful what we say!
2 At last the hospital has admitted to a _____ , so Susan will be getting some compensation.
3 We're putting together a new exhibition, so the museum is a _____ at the moment.
4 I've just tried to tell some boys to put their litter in a bin instead of dropping it on the pavement, but all I got for my trouble was a _____ .
5 We all went out to search for the children, but it turned out they were _____ at Laura's house all the time.
6 My suggestion that we go skiing at Easter certainly met with a _____ from the rest of the family.
7 I told my daughter that if she doesn't keep her room _____ , she won't get any pocket money.
8 The family seem to expect me to do all the cooking and all the housework and I'm _____ of it!
9 I'm a _____ at the moment because I'm expecting my exam results tomorrow.
10 It's very difficult to remain _____ when people are shouting at you from all directions.

9 **Put the phrases in the correct order to make sentences. Add punctuation where necessary.**

1 the wedding/the house was/the morning before/a hive of activity
2 before speaking/a bundle of nerves/I'm always/in public
3 sick and tired/I'm absolutely/after everyone/of cleaning up
4 is always/in her office/neat and tidy/everything
5 I'll be happier/back safe and sound/everyone is/when I know
6 and out came/he opened/a torrent of abuse/his mouth

REVIEW

Units 1–4

These exercises use collocations from units 1-4, and will help you see how many you have remembered. After each exercise, add up your score to see how well you have done.

1 **Complete the sentences.**

1 I went to bed, but it took me a long time to fall _____ .
2 I was late because of the _____ traffic.
3 She sustained serious _____ in the accident.
4 I was late home and my mum was _____ sick.
5 Our whole family moved to Australia to make a fresh _____ .
6 It's not often I read a book that's funny enough to make me _____ aloud.
7 When they hadn't come down from the mountain by 6p.m., I decided to _____ the alarm.
8 Before then, I hadn't realised the _____ extent of the problem.
9 Scientists have made a _____ breakthrough in the battle to defeat the disease.
10 She was able to give the police a detailed _____ of her attacker.

Score: ☐ / 10

2 **Underline the correct word to complete the collocations.**

1 The police describe it as a **rough/brutal/strong attack** on an innocent woman.
2 The **injuries** that he **obtained/retrieved/sustained** were not life-threatening.
3 Weather experts have **issued/spread/proclaimed** a **warning** of possible flooding in the area.
4 As I stepped out onto the stage, my **heart** was **knocking/pounding/crashing**.
5 I **slept** really **profoundly/soundly/strongly** on holiday because I was so relaxed.
6 I wanted to make a **favourable/important/delighted impression** on my new boss.
7 They had no **whole/considerable/conclusive proof** of his guilt.
8 All the former shops and restaurants are **standing/remaining/leaning empty** now.
9 I took a **smart/bright/brisk walk** around the park.
10 I can't imagine Sam flying into a rage – she's always so **peaceful/even/calm and collected**.

Score: ☐ / 10

3 **Match the collocations 1–10 to the definitions a–j.**

1	to make cars use a different route	**a**	freshly baked
2	to be a danger to something or someone	**b**	safe and sound
3	someone who has never done an activity before	**c**	nasty surprise
4	cooked very recently	**d**	spread rumours
5	an unpleasant shock	**e**	catalogue of errors
6	not harmed or damaged	**f**	grow accustomed to
7	get used to	**g**	pose a threat
8	with very little light	**h**	complete beginner
9	a large number of mistakes	**i**	dimly lit
10	to tell other people personal things about someone	**j**	divert traffic

Score: ☐ / 10

4 **Match the two halves of the sentences.**

1	She was admitted to hospital	**a**	as a brilliant public speaker.
2	The holiday company	**b**	an area of great natural beauty.
3	She felt faint and	**c**	is freely available from libraries.
4	He has travelled extensively	**d**	denied responsibility for the boating accident.
5	Information of this sort	**e**	her legs buckled under her.
6	After twelve hours of torrential rain,	**f**	throughout Asia and Africa.
7	She's in the enviable position	**g**	the centre of the town was flooded.
8	He opened his mouth and	**h**	out came a torrent of abuse.
9	He quickly earned a reputation	**i**	suffering from breathing difficulties.
10	The have a home in the Pyrenees –	**j**	of not having to work.

Score: ☐ / 10

5 **Correct the word in *italics* to make a collocation with the word in bold in each sentence.**

1. We live in a *thickly* **populated** area.
2. The attack happened in *full* **daylight**.
3. The film was launched in a *blast* of **publicity**.
4. I'm *ill* and **tired** of your excuses!
5. There is a *flowering* **romance** between Joe and Linda.
6. I was a *bunch* of **nerves** before the exam.
7. They keep their house *tirelessly* **clean**.
8. My suggestion met with a *burst* of **approval**.
9. It was a *decisive* **attempt** to humiliate me.
10. I didn't expect to like the food. I was *nicely* **surprised**.

Score: ☐ / 10

6 **Complete the sentences with collocations from the box. Use the correct form of the verbs.**

war breaks out • attach importance • talk openly • assume control • seize an opportunity • ignore warning • launch an attack • restore confidence • earthquakes strike • start afresh

1. He joined the army shortly after _____ .
2. If we continue to _____ about climate change, it will soon be too late.
3. He _____ great _____ to good manners.
4. These measures are an attempt by the government to _____ in the economy.
5. The _____ in the middle of the night, devastating the city centre.
6. I had to go to Sydney on business, so while I was there, I _____ to visit my sister.
7. Many children find it difficult to _____ with their parents about relationships.
8. She used the article to _____ on the government's defence policy.
9. He had so many bad memories, he decided to move away and _____ .
10. Since the latest coup, the military has _____ of the country.

Score: ☐ / 10

Total score: ☐ / 60

5

COLLOCATIONS FOR GOOD AND BAD

The good side ...

These exercises focus on adjective + noun collocations to do with positive things. Note that it is important to learn the correct adjectives, because it is often the case that other adjectives – even ones with similar meanings – would not sound right to a native speaker of English.

Sound natural

When you are learning new collocations, try to use your own examples to make them more memorable.

1 **Circle the correct adjective to complete the collocation in each sentence.**

1 Four members of staff interviewed her and she made a very _____ **impression** on all of them.
a favourable **b** encouraging **c** supportive

2 He got a _____ **reference** from his previous employer.
a gleaming **b** glittering **c** glowing

3 Yes, he's good at his job and he's very good-looking but he has a rather _____ **opinion** of himself.
a tall **b** high **c** big

4 Germany's top tennis player gave another _____ **performance**.
a solid **b** secure **c** firm

5 Spain got off to a _____ **start**, scoring twice in the first ten minutes.
a optimistic **b** happy **c** promising

6 He won the award at the age of twenty-two which is a _____ **achievement**.
a remarkable **b** prominent **c** marked

7 With his qualifications and determination, this young man should have a very _____ **future** in front of him.
a light **b** bright **c** shiny

8 She was a very _____ **student** – in the top five percent in her year.
a able **b** powerful **c** worthy

9 His first novel sold over six million copies. It was a _____ **success**.
a vast **b** giant **c** huge

10 This is a _____ **example** of the architecture of the period.
a prime **b** premium **c** premier

2 **Replace the underlined phrases with collocations from Exercise 1.**

1 It is a very successful beginning to the game for France's top tennis player.
2 Running two marathons in two days is a very impressive thing to have done at any age.
3 She was twenty-two, with fantastic qualifications and a successful life to come ahead of her.
4 His teachers all described him as a very clever pupil.
5 I have a very good judgement of all the teachers at the school.
6 She worked for us for six years and I gave her an excellent description of her abilities and work when she left.
7 This is a perfect type of sixteenth century Italian sculpture.
8 Her latest film has been extremely popular.
9 The young Spanish actress gives another very good piece of acting.
10 From what John said, Nina had clearly made him admire her.

CLASSROOM EXTRA

In pairs, students answer the questions.
1 Name a film, book, etc., that has been a huge success in recent years.
2 Give an example of a remarkable sporting achievement.
3 Name someone who you think has a bright future.
4 Name a celebrity or politician that you have a high opinion of and give your reasons.

3 **Complete the sentences 1–10 with the collocations you have learned above. Then match them with the people a–j.**

1. He has another two years at university, but he did extremely well in his first year exams, so he has made a _____ _____.
2. I'm not happy with Anna's work even though she got a _____ _____ from her last employer.
3. Bret is a very _____ _____. I'm confident he'll pass his end-of-term exams.
4. This young tennis player has put in a _____ _____ in his first Grand Slam tournament.
5. Our son had such a _____ _____ ahead of him. We can't imagine why he would throw it all away.
6. The first candidate was knowledgeable and pleasant. She made a very _____ _____ on me.
7. I've worked with Julia for over twenty years now and I have a very _____ _____ of her.
8. The product has been a _____ _____ in our European markets, outselling all its competitors.
9. To have played as well as you have done for all these years is a _____ _____. I am delighted to present you with this award!
10. This is a _____ _____ of this style of painting.

a someone's boss
b sports commentator
c university tutor
d parents
e teacher
f presenter at an awards ceremony
g colleague
h art specialist
i company director
j interviewer for a job

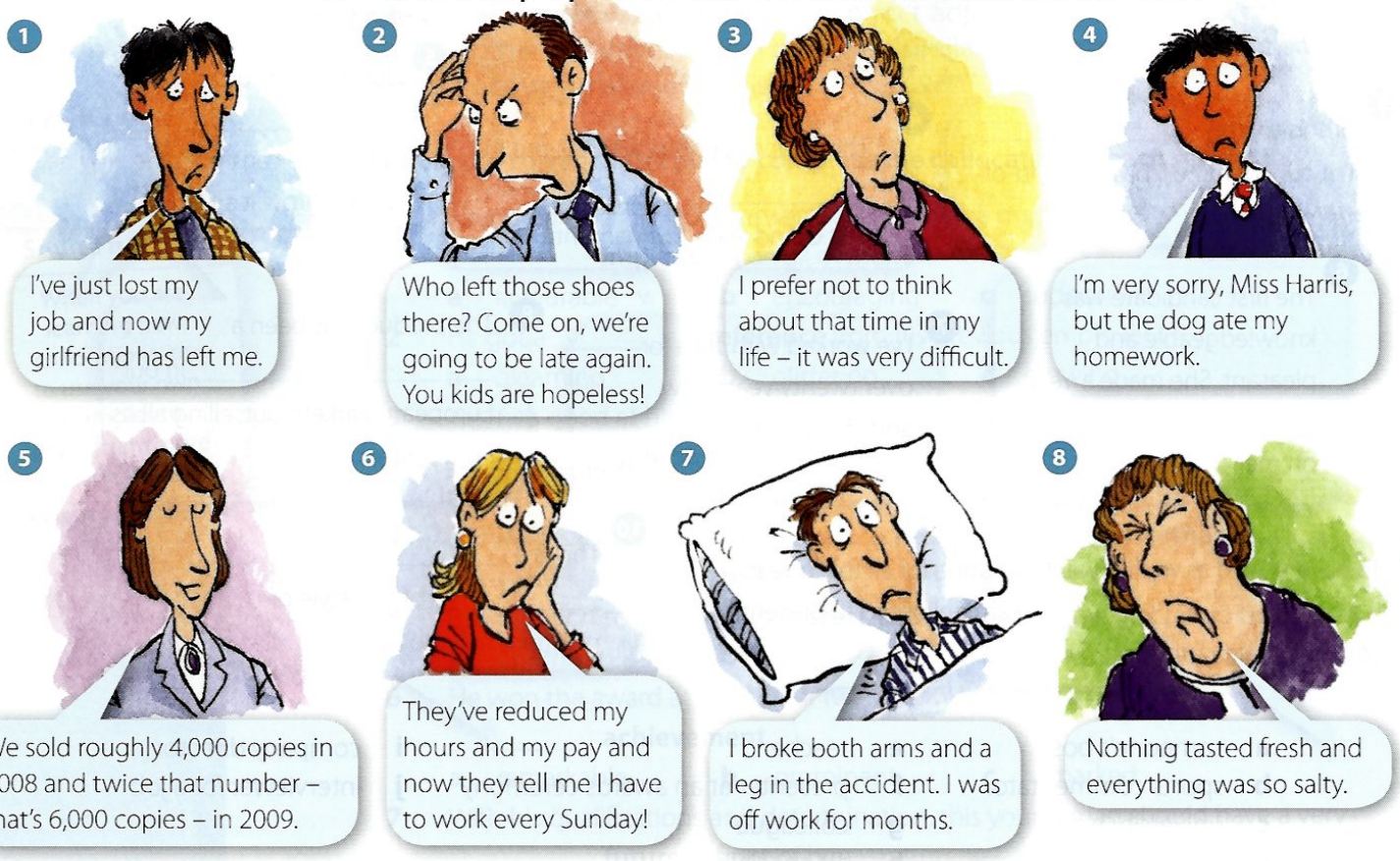
4 **Rewrite the sentences so that they mean the opposite, using the collocations in brackets.**

1. This is a very poor beginning to the season for Arsenal. (promising start)
   This is a very promising start to the season for Arsenal.
2. The film was a complete failure in every country. (huge success)
   The film was a _____.
3. She didn't do well at school. (able student)
   She was an _____.
4. These companies have a very difficult time ahead of them. (bright future)
   These companies _____.
5. His last employers gave a bad account of his time with them. (glowing reference)
   _____ *gave him* _____.
6. When I first met her, I wasn't at all impressed by her. (favourable impression)
   When I first met her, she made _____.
7. United played fairly badly this afternoon. (solid performance)
   United gave _____.
8. Getting a degree at his age is nothing special. (remarkable achievement)
   Getting a degree at his age _____.
9. He doesn't think his boss is very good. (high opinion)
   He has a _____.
10. This is not a typical painting from this period. (prime example)
    This is a _____.

The bad side ...

These exercises focus on adjective + noun collocations for negative things. Make sure you learn the correct adjectives to use in order to sound fluent and natural.

5 **Match the people 1–8 with the sentences a–h that describe them.**



a Maria made a **glaring error**.
b Carla has very **painful memories** of that period.
c William made a very **lame excuse**.
d Carole remarked on the **poor quality** of the food.
e Paolo suffered **horrific injuries** in the crash.
f Philip has had a **rough time** recently.
g Dad was in a **foul mood**.
h Dominique has had very **shoddy treatment** from her employers.

6 **Cover Exercise 5 and complete the sentences using the collocations you have learned.**

1 The real story here is the government's _____ **treatment** of soldiers who have spent their lives fighting for this country.
2 A headache always puts Tom in a _____ **mood**.
3 I corrected a few details in the text, but I didn't spot any _____ **errors**.
4 I was increasingly concerned at the _____ **quality** of his work.
5 It sounded like a _____ **excuse** but I really *did* feel too ill to go out.
6 Going back to the hospital where her mother died brought back some _____ **memories**.
7 He's having a _____ **time** at work and doesn't feel supported by his boss.
8 Many people suffered _____ **injuries** in the bomb blast.

Study tip

Notice that all the adjectives in these collocations could be replaced with *bad*. This shows how learning collocations can develop your vocabulary.

7 **Complete the letters asking for advice with the collocations you have learned above.**

Dear Guy,

Three years ago my husband suffered [1] _____ in a car crash. He broke both legs and his pelvis we didn't know if he would walk again. He had very [2] _____ in the hospital – he was left waiting for hours before a doctor saw him. In fact, overall we were shocked at the [3] _____ of his care. Thankfully, he did make a full recovery but it took a long time and lot of patience and we have very [4] _____ of the whole period. How do we stop feeling so bitter about the experience and move on with our lives?

S Bastion, Hull

Dear Guy,

I've been having a [5] _____ at work recently. Basically, my boss is really lazy and bad-tempered and we haven't been getting on well. It all started two weeks ago when I discovered a [6] _____ in the figures of a report that he'd written. I pointed it out to him and he immediately made a [7] _____, saying the sales figures were different on different databases. He claimed it was the fault of the sales managers. He's been in a [8] _____ ever since and some days he barely even speaks to me. What can I do to improve relations between us?

Katie, Marlow

8 **Rewrite the sentences so that they mean the opposite, using collocations from the box. Note the verbs and prepositions that go with each collocation – you will need to learn these too in order to use the collocations.**

suffer **horrific injuries** • have **painful memories** • lots of **glaring errors** • of **poor quality** • make a **lame excuse** • in a **foul mood** • have a **rough time** • receive **shoddy treatment**

1 She was barely hurt at all in the accident.
She suffered horrific injuries in the accident.
2 There were one or two little mistakes in the report.
3 The clothes were very well made.
4 Juan gave a very valid reason for not helping out.
5 She's been treated very well by the company she works for.
6 I remember my school days with great affection.
7 His life is going well at the moment.
8 She seemed very happy and pleased to see everyone this morning.

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Read the following questions and give yourself a moment to think about them. Then, in pairs, ask each other the questions and give your answers.

1 Has anyone ever given you a **lame excuse**?
2 What puts you in a **foul mood**?
3 Have you ever had **shoddy treatment** from an employer?
4 When did you last buy something that was of **poor quality**?

6 COLLOCATIONS FOR SUCCESS

Keep trying

The collocations in these exercises show a variety of ways to express the idea of succeeding in doing or getting something. They are used in contexts such as work and careers, sports or achieving personal goals.

1 **Match the two halves of the sentences.**

1	After three days of negotiations, he	**a**	in a law company.
2	He's just **landed** a top **job**	**b**	working hard and effectively.
3	She finally **achieved** her **ambition** to	**c**	the talks fail to **produce results**.
4	We will have to explore other options if	**d**	become a doctor.
5	She quickly **acquired** a **reputation** as	**e**	finally **clinched** the **deal**.
6	He **earned** his boss's **respect** by	**f**	a very good businesswoman.
7	We have to **meet** this **deadline** or	**g**	**accomplish** a **task**.
8	I get a sense of satisfaction when I	**h**	the whole project will fail.

2 **Look at the magazine article. Put the sentences in the correct order so that the paragraphs make sense.**







THIS MONTH'S **CARLA MAGAZINE** HAS A FEATURE ON STARTING OUT IN THE WORLD OF WORK. THREE WOMEN HAVE WRITTEN ABOUT THEIR EXPERIENCES OF STARTING A CAREER.

1 GINNIE

a I didn't mind the hard work because at last I had **achieved** my **ambition**.

b Finally, in 2004, I **landed** a **job** as a fashion editor for a national newspaper.

c It was the job of my dreams and I worked hard, sometimes staying in the office till midnight to write a piece if I had to **meet** a **deadline**.

d I'd been trying to get into fashion journalism for a while, sending off articles to magazines and newspapers and applying for permanent positions.

2 RIFAT

a Today, thirteen years later, I have my own dental practice and I employ eight people.

b This willingness to work long hours soon **earned** me the **respect** of my colleagues and I was quickly promoted.

c I got my first job in a dental practice when I was twenty-six.

d I was the youngest person there but I quickly **acquired** a **reputation** for being hard-working, putting in a ten- or eleven-hour day if that was what was needed to **accomplish** a **task**.

3 KATE

a I would shout and bully people to get what I wanted.

b When I got my first job in a bank, it was a very male-dominated profession.

c I decided that I would be as competitive and as aggressive as my male colleagues, so I went into every meeting determined to **clinch** the **deal**.

d This sort of aggressive, typically male behaviour **produced results** and today I earn a six-figure salary.

3 **How motivated are you? Answer these questions by choosing *a*, *b* or *c*, and our life coach Guy Grounded will tell you.**

How motivated are you?

1 Do you always accomplish a task once you have started it?
- **a** Yes, of course!
- **b** I usually try to finish what I've started.
- **c** To be honest, I'm not great at finishing off things.

2 How important is it for you to meet deadlines?
- **a** Absolutely essential.
- **b** It's important but you have to recognise that sometimes it just isn't possible.
- **c** I don't think I've met a deadline in my life.

3 To land your dream job, what would you do?
- **a** Anything. My career is everything to me.
- **b** Send my CV to the relevant company, speak to the right people – you know, the usual things.
- **c** Dream job – what are you talking about?

4 Do you have any ambitions that you want to achieve?
- **a** Too many to list!
- **b** Yes, like most people I have career ambitions.
- **c** I've got one – to work as little as possible.

5 If something that you are trying to achieve does not immediately produce results, how do you react?
- **a** I work at it until I get the results I want.
- **b** I'm a bit discouraged but I keep trying.
- **c** Oh forget it – life's too short!

6 If by the end of a meeting, you had failed to clinch a deal, how would you feel?
- **a** Me, fail to clinch a deal? The word 'fail' isn't in my vocabulary!
- **b** Pretty disappointed – I'd ask myself where I'd gone wrong.
- **c** Whatever! That's life, isn't it? You win some, you lose some.

7 Have you acquired a reputation for being a hard-worker?
- **a** Yes, certainly.
- **b** Well, I hope so.
- **c** Me, a hard-worker? Are you joking?

8 How do you, personally, earn the respect of your colleagues/classmates?
- **a** By working hard and producing results. It's the only way.
- **b** By doing my best and treating other people with respect.
- **c** Don't ask me!

Guy Grounded says:

MOSTLY A'S
Wow! Your feet don't touch the ground, do they? You're always out there, chasing your dreams and achieving your ambitions and I admire that. People like you make the world keep turning. Just make sure you stop to smell the flowers once in a while!

MOSTLY B'S
Congratulations! You have achieved the all-important work-life balance. Yes, you have ambitions and goals and you work hard to achieve them, but you have a personal life too and that is important. Keep it up and you will enjoy a satisfying career and good relationships with the people you care about. And remember, your great strength is that you are not afraid to fail.

MOSTLY C'S
You slacker*! You can scarcely force yourself to get out of bed in the morning, can you? But I suspect that you are not being entirely truthful with me. Yes, you value your free time, but is there really nothing in life that you would like to achieve? Some small goal – short-term or long-term – that would give your life meaning and interest? Focus your thoughts on this for a little while and you might just find there is.

* slacker: (informal) a lazy person

CLASSROOM EXTRA

If this is being done in class, ask students to interview one another, rather than doing the questionnaire individually.

You can do it

Study tip

Look at these collocations and think about where you would be likely to find them and when you might need to use them.

4 **Solve the anagram in brackets to complete the collocations in the sentences.**

1 Eventually she **fulfilled** her _____ and went to live in Australia. (radem)
2 The party failed to **win** the _____ of the voters. (urppost)
3 Manchester United **secured** a _____ last night in the third round of the tournament. (yrivtco)
4 As a teacher you have to work hard to **capture** your students' _____ . (ternites)
5 How do you suppose criminals **gain** _____ to records such as these? (cescas)
6 Do you have to **obtain** _____ to see these documents or can anyone see them? (pnrisseoim)
7 They've **scored** a great _____ with their latest product – it's outselling all its competitors. (escuscs)
8 Work hard now and you will **reap** the _____ later. (tenebfis)

5 **Match the sentences 1–8 to the speakers a–h.**

1 We've scored a great success with our latest advertising campaign.

2 Somehow, criminals have succeeded in gaining access to these records.

3 I managed to obtain permission from the library to see the original documents.

4 Tim and I put a lot of effort into training our kids to sleep when they were babies but we're really reaping the benefits now because they both sleep through the night.

5 If we can secure a victory in the game tonight, we'll be four points ahead at the top of the table.

6 I always try to capture my readers' interest in the first few lines of a novel.

7 That was the year I fulfilled a dream by completing the New York marathon.

8 I am confident that we will win the support of the people at the next election.

a a parent
b a politician
c a jogger
d a student
e a supporter of a football team
f an author
g a police officer
h the chief executive officer of a company

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Write the following people on the board: *film director, businessperson, researcher, footballer, politician, ballet dancer.* In pairs, students should choose two people and write sentences about them, using the collocations they have learned, as in Exercise 5. They then swap with another pair and guess which people the sentences describe.



6 **Read the introduction to a radio programme, *Speaking Personally*. Complete the introduction with the collocations you have learned. Listen to the recording to check your answers.**

My first guest, Emma Plant, has been writing all her life. By the time she was thirty, she'd had three novels published, none of which sold in great numbers. With her fourth novel, *Lizzie's Shoes*, however, she **scored** a great [1]_____. The book has been in the top fifty best-seller list ever since its publication in 2008. *Lizzie's Shoes* tells the story of the real-life feminist and polar explorer, Elizabeth De Freville. To research the book, Plant managed to **gain** [2]_____ to De Freville's private letters. It took all her powers of persuasion to **obtain** [3]_____ from De Freville's family to do so. The secret to story-telling, says Plant, is to **capture** the reader's [4]_____ from the first page.

My second guest, Daniella Sparkes, is just back from Australia, having **secured** her first grand-slam [5]_____. She has **won** the [6]_____ of fans the world over with her combination of brilliance and charm. Daniella is quite open about the fact that she is obsessive about her training, getting up at 5a.m. most days to swim and jog. Well, she's certainly **reaping** the [7]_____ of all that training. Aged just twenty-three, she is among the top five women tennis players in the land. Whether she will this year **fulfil** her [8]_____ by winning Wimbledon remains to be seen.

7 **Complete the sentences using the collocations from Exercise 4.**

1 They certainly _____ a _____ with their next album which rapidly became the best-selling album of all time.
2 These are top-secret documents – it's almost impossible to _____ _____ to them.
3 Her suggestions for radical changes in working practices failed to _____ the _____ of her colleagues.
4 When you're giving a talk, you have to start with something that will really _____ your audience's _____.
5 She eventually managed to _____ _____ to visit her brother in prison.
6 Both teams, of course, hope to _____ a _____ that will take them through to the next round of the competition.
7 One day he hoped to _____ his _____ of becoming an actor.
8 They worked long hours to establish the company but they're certainly _____ the _____ now with fantastic sales.

8 **Put the phrases in the correct order to make sentences. Add punctuation where necessary.**

1 to gain/highly confidential information/she had managed/somehow/access to
2 of new/reap/medical advances/we all/the benefits
3 captured/the film/certainly/my interest
4 I fulfilled/later that year/of dancing/my dream/for the Royal Ballet
5 in winning/of 40 percent of the voters/they succeeded/the support
6 the first victory/United/of the season today/secured
7 with her second film/but she scored/a box-office failure/her first film was/a success
8 the records/to see/we obtained/eventually/permission

7 COLLOCATIONS FOR IMPORTANCE

Get your priorities right

The collocations in these exercises express the idea of importance. Notice that many of them are very emphatic – people use them when they feel strongly about something.

1 **Read the newspaper article. Check that you understand all the words, using a dictionary to help you if necessary. Then read the article again, and find two-word collocations to match meanings 1–10.**

IT'S 'BIN' A FAILURE

Recent research in Newtown shows that many people are not recycling as much as the council would like. Mike Evans, a key figure in the council's 'Green Team', says, 'The chief reason why people aren't recycling seems to be that our system is too complicated. There is a pressing need for a simple system that everyone can use. All our customer surveys show that recycling has to be our top priority in waste services.'

Local resident and mum-of-three, Katie Morris, agrees. 'For me, the major problem is remembering what goes in each box, and which day it gets collected. It's a prime example of a well-intentioned scheme that has been badly thought through. I've heard that some areas have a system where everything is collected together and then sorted out later. I think the council should give serious consideration to that idea.'

Dr Ali Mirza, of Beech Road, has other concerns. 'It is of vital importance that we do everything we can to combat global warming. Nobody can doubt that it is the burning issue of our time. But we need to target our resources carefully – money is limited, so we need to use it in the most effective way possible. Even leading experts are divided on whether it is worthwhile to recycle plastic, for instance.'

1 important person key figure
2 most important goal _____
3 very urgent requirement _____
4 important difficulty _____
5 great importance _____
6 careful thought _____
7 perfect case _____
8 very important subject _____
9 people who know most about a subject _____
10 main explanation _____

2 **Look at the newspaper article again and answer the questions. Each answer should contain the collocation in brackets.**

1 Why did the journalist interview Mike Evans? (key figure)
2 Why aren't people recycling enough? (chief reason)
3 Does Mike Evans think a simpler system should be introduced? (pressing need)
4 What do customer surveys say about recycling? (top priority)
5 Why is it difficult for Katie Morris to recycle her waste? (major problem)
6 Has the present system been well-planned? (prime example)
7 What does Katie Morris think the council should do? (serious consideration)
8 Does Ali Mirza think we can ignore global warming? (vital importance)
9 How important does Ali Mirza think the issue of global warming is? (burning issue)
10 Why is Ali Mirza doubtful about recycling plastic? (leading experts)

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Ask your students to pick three collocations from those they have learned and write three sentences expressing their own views on environmental issues. Then ask them either to discuss them with their neighbours or have a class discussion.

3 **Read e-mails from two senior department managers at Sedgwick Medical Equipment which suggest the best way to save their failing company. Use the collocations you have learned above to complete their e-mails.**

From: Rick Prentice
To: Helen Green
Subject: Marketing Team

At this stage, more consultancy is a complete waste of money. In fact, in my opinion, it's a [1]_____ _____ of the lack of confidence and inability to take decisions that has got us into this mess in the first place. What we need is a much bigger marketing spend, targeted at [2]_____ _____ in the industry. The [3]_____ _____ we are failing is that important potential customers simply don't know about our products. It is of [4]_____ _____ for us to target these people with visits from reps and really glossy promotional materials. In my opinion, we should give really [5]_____ _____ to increasing the marketing team, at least temporarily.

From: Kirsty Graves
To: Helen Green
Subject: Expert advice

Marketing alone will never convince professionals like these to buy our products. In my opinion, our most [6]_____ _____ is for more advice and support that will give our products real credibility. At the moment, we have a [7]_____ _____ convincing customers that our development team is strong enough. Professor Levy is a [8]_____ _____ in the field of anaesthesia, and to have him associated with us would be a major step forward. Improved anaesthesia is one of the [9]_____ _____ in medicine today, and with him on board we would have no problem generating publicity. I strongly believe that our [10]_____ _____ should be to hire him as a consultant, whatever the cost.

4 **Pupils attending a school reunion were asked to write something about their schooldays and their lives since then. Eight of this writer's adjectives have got muddled up. Put them in the correct order to see what she said.**

My English teacher, Mrs Evans, was a ~~prime~~ key figure in my education, and the vital reason why I went on to study English at university. She made me realise that getting a good education is of top importance, and because of her, I made it my serious priority to do well in my exams. In her classes, we were encouraged to express ourselves freely, and we discussed all the leading issues of the day. She really opened our minds.

At university, I was lucky enough to have Professor Roach, a chief expert in Shakespeare studies, as my tutor. I have now almost completed my degree, and am giving key consideration to a career as a school teacher myself. Mrs Evans is a burning example of the sort of teacher who has an enormous influence on pupils' lives.

Working towards your goals



5 **Suzie is young, full of energy and doesn't think much of rules and regulations. Match the sentence halves to discover her views.**

1 Plenty of money and the use of a car are
2 Once you're a teenager, you don't care about your family so much –
3 Basically, for most people, physical attractiveness is the
4 If I had to say what my most **notable achievement** has been,
5 Deciding to have a baby is
6 My parents say their **overriding concern** is for my safety, but
7 The way you look definitely plays a **prominent role** in
8 When I decide on my career, a good salary

a how successful you are in life.
b the most **momentous decision** anyone has to make in their lives.
c **decisive factor** when people are looking for a girlfriend or boyfriend.
d it's your friends who have a **central role** in your life.
e will be **of paramount importance**.
f I'd say it was getting my dad to buy me a horse!
g the **essential ingredients** of a good weekend.
h I think they just want to spoil my fun.

CLASSROOM EXTRA

Ask your students to discuss whether or not they agree with Suzie's views. Ask them to write some sentences expressing their own views, using the collocations they have learned. Ask them to read them out, and the class should vote on whether they agree or disagree.

6 **Complete the sentences using the collocations you have learned above.**

1 Last year, we sold our house, packed up all our possessions and moved to this farm in France. It was a _____ _____ for us, but we were tired of working in an office.
2 Nobody wants to send their children to a school where the exam results are so poor. High grades are a _____ _____ in most parents' choice.
3 The government has allocated a multi-million pound grant in an effort to improve life in this area. We want local people to play a _____ _____ in deciding exactly how the money is to be spent.
4 We have always said that we will not deal with terrorists. We stress, however, that our _____ _____ is for the safe return of all the hostages.
5 When we take people rock climbing, it is a real thrill to see them overcome their fear. Of course, safety is of _____ _____, and all our instructors are fully trained.
6 Our hotel is booked up months in advance. We believe that a warm welcome and attention to detail are _____ _____ for a pleasant holiday.
7 I don't believe that politicians should involve their families in their work. I certainly never expected my husband to play a _____ _____ in my election campaign.
8 He rose from being a cook in a pizza restaurant to the head of an international law firm. It really is a _____ _____, especially considering his violent home background.

7 **Complete the sentences so that they express the opposite view, using the collocations in brackets.**

1 Timo was not involved in setting up the drama group. (central role)
Timo played a central role in setting up _____ the drama group.

2 I don't really care if we don't have much sunshine on holiday. (essential ingredient)
For me, _____ *of a good holiday.*

3 Changing career wasn't that important for me. (momentous decision)
Changing career was _____ .

4 Making profits was the least important factor for us. (overriding concern)
Making profits was _____ .

5 The weather was not important for the army's victory. (decisive factor)
_____ *in the army's victory.*

6 If I were buying a house, the location wouldn't be particularly important. (of paramount importance)
If I were buying a house, _____ .

7 She wasn't very impressed by his history of World War II. (notable achievement)
She thought his _____ .

8 She is not really involved in national politics. (prominent role)
She plays a _____ .

8 **Complete the sentences using the collocations you have learned above.**

1 The sunny weather was a _____ _____ in our decision to live here.

2 Good food hygiene is of _____ _____ when you are running a restaurant.

3 After years of working in a job she hated, she took the _____ _____ to sell her house and travel round the world.

4 An interesting main character is an _____ _____ in any good novel.

5 For someone of his background, becoming a barrister was a _____ _____ .

6 My _____ _____ is for the children's safety.

Sound natural

It is useful to learn collocations relating to the idea of importance because we use them so often, for example when we are giving reasons or opinions.